

Twenty-one Guns

Digit will never be the same again without these heroes

Each month we share with you our experiences in bringing out your favourite technology magazine. Some of our behind-the-scenes activities are adventurous, some funny and some just involve a lot of hard work in overcoming unexpected hurdles. But never before have we faced a tragedy of this magnitude.

We got the news in the wee hours of Sunday, the 28th of July that five of our team members, Akhilesh Singh, Arup Ghosh and Sourav Ghosh from our Circulation and Logistics team, and C.M. Krishnan and Kiran Desai from our Accounts department had met with a fatal accident on the highway between Bhopal and Indore. They were on yet another road trip aimed at increasing the reach of Digit in several smaller towns and cities.

The news sent shock waves throughout the company and we still find it hard to believe that these five will not turn up one day, dusty from the road, with some more unbelievable tales of their intrepid adventures.

Akhilesh was a stalwart, one of the oldest members in the team. As head of the Circulation and Logistics team, he was responsible for ensuring that Digit reached every corner of India on time, come hailstorm or high water.

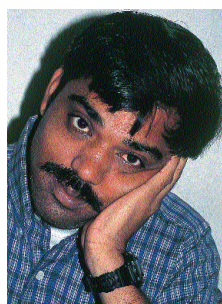


Akhilesh had strong personal ties with everybody he worked with and also with his trade partners, scattered across the country. Though a taskmaster at work, he was looked upon as an elder brother and mentor by many of the younger members of his team. Always ready to meet any challenge head-on, he had this innate knack of getting the impossible done. Also, no get-together was complete without him—his 'moon-walking-underwater-cum-belly-dance' routine used to be

the popular demand at each and every party.

Akhilesh leaves behind his grieving parents, an older brother and two older sisters. He was engaged to be married this November.

Arup was assistant manager, Circulation and Logistics. A true team player, he was level headed and dependable in



any situation, always willing to take up any challenge thrown at him. Arup joined us in December 1999 and was always ready to lend a helping hand to others, irrespective of whether

he was bogged down with his own work.

An ace rally driver, his passion for cars was rivalled only by his passion for cooking. In fact, he was the *de facto* cook at all office parties, where we would gather together and hold a huge cook-in under his expert guidance.

He is survived by his parents and an older sister.

Sourav was a very jovial person with a booming, infectious laugh. He joined the Logistics team in April 2001 as manager, magazine sales having previously worked with the Gawhati-based publication, *Anand Bazaar Patrika* and brought with him extensive knowledge and experience about magazine distribution in India.



Though he'd been with us for just over a year, he was regarded as an indispensable member of the team.

Just before the accident, Sourav had gone to Kolkata on leave and wasn't going to be on this particular trip. But he joined the rest of his team members on

his way back from Kolkata as his presence would make a big difference to their morale.

Sourav leaves behind a grieving wife and a three-year-old son.

Kiran was our manager, Accounts. His tolerance in handling even the most demanding situations lent a stabilising effect to the hectic working style of the



Accounts department. Always keeping a low profile, Kiran let his actions speak for themselves. Today, his expert financial systems help manage the accounts for the entire JS Group. As a

friend, he had always guided his fellow workers and stood by them during all their problems, whether professional or personal.

Kiran is survived by his mother, wife and a young daughter studying in Class 10.

Krishnan was a perfect foil to Kiran. His enthusiasm made the most difficult of tasks look easy. He was always the fun-loving guy who would release the tensions in the Accounts department. His second innings with the JS Group started when he joined as manager, Credit Control, and took over the entire credit



functions of Jasubhai Digital Media. The adept handling of our company's funds and cash flow was indeed a 'credit' to him.

Krishnan leaves behind a wife, a son studying in class 11 and a daughter studying in class 7.

As colleagues, friends and truly wonderful people, they will be sorely missed. ■